

stood out. Antonelli (**right**) claimed three memorable podiums in Canada, Brazil, and an inherited finish in Las Vegas. The Italian's consistency — reaching Q3 sixteen times, second only to Hamilton's 2007 rookie record of seventeen — hinted at a future star still sharpening his racecraft, with much more to come.

Not far behind in intrigue was Isack Hadjar at Racing Bulls. The Frenchman's tenure began with a harsh introduction as he suffered a formation-lap crash in Australia. But in a team that lacked the machinery of the front-runners, Hadjar's ability to extract performance from every session was remarkable.

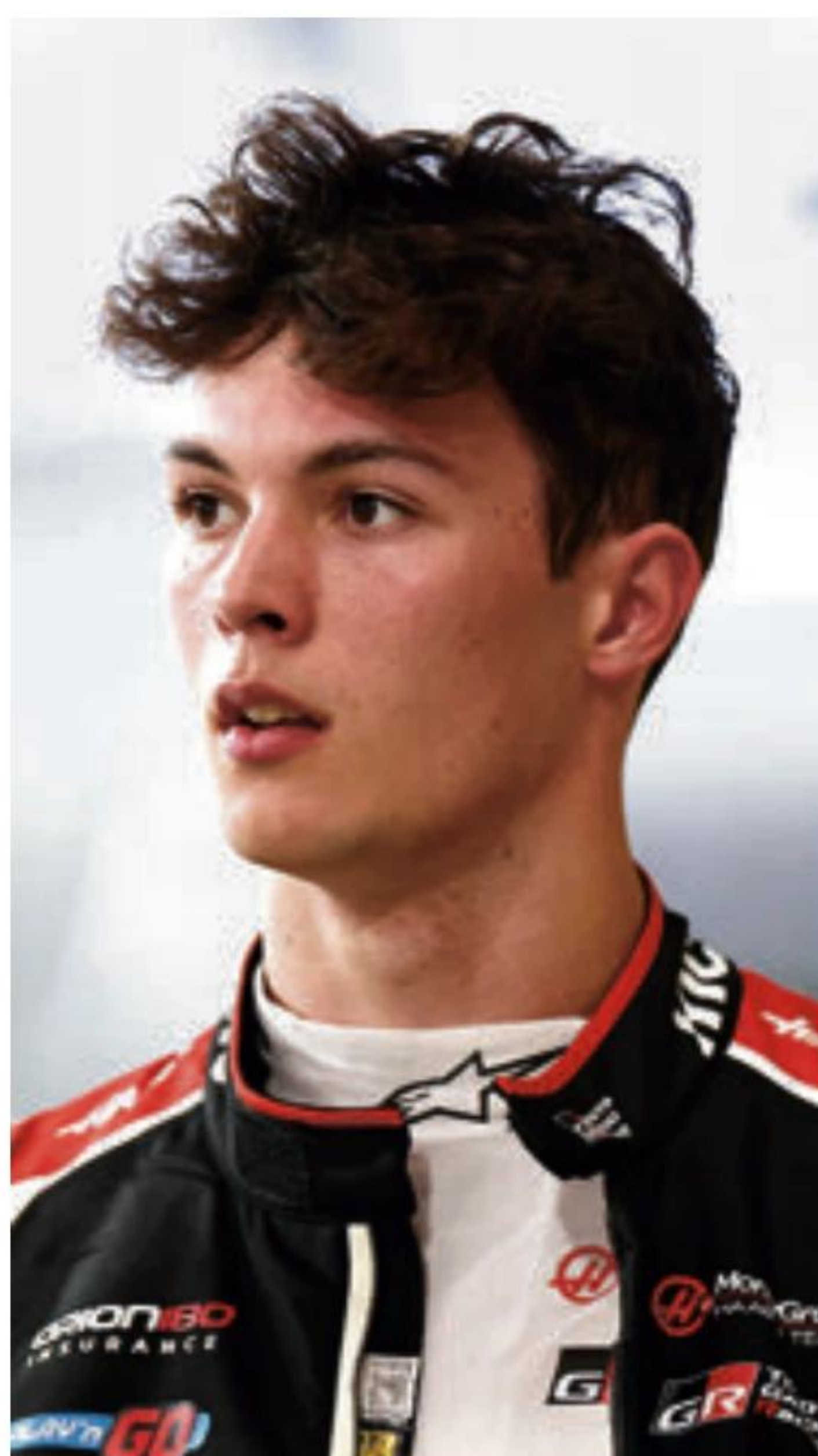
Single-lap pace, equalling Antonelli's mark in qualifying consistency, and a hard-fought podium in the Netherlands confirmed his skill set. By race 23, he had earned a promotion to the Red Bull second seat — a cursed revolving door that could define the next stage of his career.

Other debutants experienced the sport's learning curve in their own ways. Haas' Oliver Bearman consistently fought within the midfield, shining in single-lap performances. The Briton is a familiar face around the paddock, having filled in at Ferrari and Haas last year. His first full season had positive returns, with a career-best finish of fourth in Mexico.

Liam Lawson turned over a new leaf after a challenging start with the senior squad. The Kiwi, who had made sporadic outings with Racing Bulls since 2023, endured two difficult races with Red Bull before being reassigned. He gradually regained form and delivered a fifth-place finish in Azerbaijan, securing his seat and another chance to prove his capabilities.

For Gabriel Bortoleto, Sauber offered both opportunity and challenge. The Brazilian entered F1 after dominating junior categories, but the team's limited development this year meant extracting performance was often a test of patience.

Yet a sixth-place finish in Hungary and multiple points finishes



OLIVER BEARMAN (Haas)

13th place — 41 points
Best finish — 4th (Mexico)
Reached Q3 6/24 times



LIAM LAWSON (Racing Bulls)

14th place — 38 points
Best finish — 5th (Azerbaijan)
Reached Q3 8/24 times